

Rental Trust — Context & Foundation Document

This document consolidates the vision, principles, product strategy, legal guardrails, and MVP technical foundations for the Rental Trust platform. It serves as a single source of truth for founders, engineers, advisors, and future stakeholders.

1. Core Vision

Rental Trust is not a rental marketplace. The platform exists to help tenants and landlords prove trust when renting, by enabling secure, consent-based sharing of verified rental information.

2. Problem Summary

- 1 Rental scams are increasing in major Canadian cities, especially Toronto and Vancouver.
- 2 Tenants repeatedly share sensitive documents with strangers, without control or revocation.
- 3 Landlords rely on unverifiable PDFs, screenshots, and unreliable references.
- 4 There is no portable, consent-based rental history standard in Canada.

3. Platform Positioning

- 1 Trust infrastructure, not a listings marketplace.
- 2 Neutral recorder of facts, not a decision-maker.
- 3 Tenant-owned and consent-driven by design.

4. Platform Constitution (Summary)

The platform is governed by non-negotiable rules: tenant data ownership, explicit consent, revocable access, fact-only records, source attribution, full tenant visibility, and dispute recording without arbitration.

5. Product Roadmap Overview

- 1 Phase 0–1: Secure document vault and verified landlord access (anti-scram wedge).
- 2 Phase 2: Province-compliant lease workflows and transaction enablement.
- 3 Phase 3: Portable, verified rental history based on factual outcomes.
- 4 Phase 4: Market incentives and infrastructure integrations.

6. Monetization Philosophy

Monetization is aligned with trust and neutrality. Revenue comes from workflow usage, verification services, and infrastructure access — never from selling data, scoring tenants, or influencing rental decisions.

7. MVP Technical Foundation

The MVP uses PostgreSQL as the primary database for relational integrity and auditability, with encrypted object storage for documents. The core system primitives include tenants, landlords, documents, consent shares, access logs, verification events, and rental events.

8. Data & Access Model

Consent is modeled explicitly via Share records. All access is time-bound, revocable, and logged. Historical records are append-only, source-attributed, and tenant-visible.

9. What the Platform Will Never Do

- 1 Assign risk scores or ratings to tenants or landlords.
- 2 Make accept/reject housing decisions.
- 3 Sell or repurpose user data.
- 4 Hide data or flags from tenants.

10. Long-Term Goal

Rental Trust aims to become the default rental trust infrastructure in Canada — a neutral, compliant, and widely adopted layer that enables safer rental interactions through verifiable facts and user-controlled data.